

Epilogism: A theory-free method of looking at history by accumulating facts with minimal generalization and being conscious of the side effects of making causal claims.

Epistemic arrogance: Measure the difference between what someone actually knows and how much he thinks he knows. An excess will imply arrogance, a deficit humility. An epistemocrat is someone of epistemic humility, who holds his own knowledge in greatest suspicion.

Epistemic opacity: Randomness is the result of incomplete information at some layer. It is functionally indistinguishable from “true” or “physical” randomness.

Extremistan: the province where the total can be conceivably impacted by a single observation.

Fallacy of silent evidence: Looking at history, we do not see the full story, only the rosier parts of the process.

Fooled by randomness: the general confusion between luck and determinism, which leads to a variety of superstitions with practical consequences, such as the belief that higher earnings in some professions are generated by skills when there is a significant component of luck in them.

Future blindness: our natural inability to take into account the properties of the future—like autism, which prevents one from taking into account the existence of the minds of others.

Locke’s madman: someone who makes impeccable and rigorous reasoning from faulty premises—such as Paul Samuelson, Robert Merton the minor, and Gerard Debreu—thus producing phony models of uncertainty that make us vulnerable to Black Swans.

Lottery-ticket fallacy: the naïve analogy equating an investment in collecting positive Black Swans to the accumulation of lottery tickets. Lottery tickets are not scalable.

Ludic fallacy (or uncertainty of the nerd): the manifestation of the Platonic fallacy in the study of uncertainty; basing studies of chance on the narrow world of games and dice. A-Platonic randomness has an additional layer of uncertainty concerning the rules of the game in real life. The bell curve (Gaussian), or GIF (Great Intellectual Fraud), is the application of the ludic fallacy to randomness.

Mandelbrotian Gray Swan: Black Swans that we can somewhat take into account—earthquakes, blockbuster books, stock market crashes—